



ILLUSTRATOR • INDESIGN • PHO-TOSHOP • AFFINITY

DOC NO. RL-BRAND-001-ADOBE-A REV. A RIPOSTE LABORATORIES

The best-supported surface: real swatch import, real typography, real print output.

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SEC.01

1 • LOAD THE PALETTE

`../palettes/riposte.ase` – 14 swatches in three groups (RIPOSTE / BASE, / ACCENT, / ACCENT DEEP).

APP	HOW
Illustrator	Swatches panel → menu → Open Swatch Library → Other Library...
InDesign	Swatches panel → menu → Load Swatches...
Photoshop	Swatches panel → menu → Import Swatches...
Affinity (all)	Swatches panel → menu → Import Palette → From File...

Also available: `riposte.gpl`, `riposte.sketchpalette`, `riposte.csv`, `riposte.json`.

Document colour mode:

- ▶ Screen → **RGB**, sRGB IEC61966-2.1
- ▶ Print → **CMYK**, and read `../docs/08-print.md` RL-BRAND-001-PRINT first. The ASE carries RGB values; converting to CMYK will shift **teal** hard. Specify spot inks for anything that matters.

SEC. 02

2 • TYPE

Install **JetBrains Mono** (400 / 700 / 800). OFL – embedding in a PDF is permitted.

Character styles to build:

STYLE	SIZE	WEIGHT	CASE	TRACKING (%)	LEADING
Display	74pt	ExtraBold	UPPER	-10	102%
H1	54pt	Bold	UPPER	30	115%
H2	40pt	Bold	UPPER	30	115%
H3	30pt	Bold	UPPER	30	115%
Lead	19pt	Bold	–	0	155%
Body	15pt	Regular	–	0	155%
Nav	12pt	Bold	UPPER	80	120%
Label	11pt	Bold	UPPER	100	120%
Tag	11pt	Bold	UPPER	140	120%
Spec	11pt	Bold	UPPER	160	120%
Kicker	11pt	Bold	UPPER	300	120%
Wordmark sub	–	Regular	UPPER	550	–

Adobe and Affinity both measure tracking in **1/1000 em**, so the CSS `em` value × 1000 goes straight in. Set case via the **All Caps** character attribute, not by typing caps.

For print sizes, see `../docs/08-print.md` RL-BRAND-001-PRINT – 15pt body is a screen value; on paper you want 9.5–10pt.

SEC.03

3 • OBJECTS

- ▶ **Corner radius 0.** Set Live Corners to 0 and leave them there.
- ▶ **Strokes:** 2pt structural, 0.5pt dashed dividers, 6pt accent top bars, 8pt accent left bars. Align stroke to **outside** so the border doesn't eat the fill.
- ▶ **Effects: none.** No Drop Shadow, no Inner Glow, no Feather, no Gaussian Blur.
- ▶ **Hard offsets instead:** duplicate the object, fill with the accent, send backward, offset +4pt / +4pt. Or use **Effect → Distort & Transform → Transform** with Move 4pt/4pt and 1 copy – non-destructive and editable.

SEC.04

4 • THE THREE PATTERNS

TRI-BAND

Gradient, linear, 105°, with paired stops so the boundaries are hard: pink at 0% and 36%, marigold at 36% and 64%, teal at 64% and 100%.

CHECKER

22pt ink square → 2×2 alternating block → **Object → Pattern → Make**.
Band height 26pt with 2pt ink rules top and bottom.

HARLEQUIN

34pt squares rotated 45°, alternating pink/teal, made into a pattern. Band height 38pt.

Save all three into a **Riposte** library (.ai CC Library / Affinity Assets).

SEC.05

5 • INDESIGN DOCUMENTS

SETTING	VALUE
Margins	15mm minimum, 18mm preferred
Bleed	3mm, bands extended into it
Baseline grid	Off. The system uses a stack order, not a baseline grid
Columns	Gutter 8mm (the print translation of 34px)

Master pages carry the corner marks (DOC NO., REV.), the page number, and the colophon footer. Build paragraph styles from the table in §2 and never apply local overrides.

SEC.06

6 • PHOTOSHOP

Photoshop is for photo treatment, and the brand barely uses photography. If you must:

- ▶ Flat, high contrast, on bone. Never soft, never rounded, never vignetted.
- ▶ No layer styles – every one of them is a blur, a bevel or a glow.
- ▶ Export at 2× for screen. PNG for flat artwork, not JPEG.

SEC.07

7 • EXPORT

TARGET	FORMAT
Web raster	PNG-24 (flat art), 2× for retina
Web vector	SVG, fonts converted to outlines or the CSS font stack referenced
Print	PDF/X-4, fonts embedded, 3mm bleed, crop marks
Office handoff	PDF, or PNG at 300dpi

Before any print export, run the checklist in `../docs/08-print`.
`mdRL-BRAND-001-PRINT` — especially the **1.5pt minimum rule weight**.

SEC.08

8 • CHECKLIST

- ☐ `riposte.ase` loaded
- ☐ JetBrains Mono installed, character styles built
- ☐ Radius 0, Live Corners 0
- ☐ No effects — hard offsets built from duplicated objects
- ☐ Strokes $\geq 1.5\text{pt}$ for print
- ☐ Accents rotating in order
- ☐ Colophon on the last page

SOURCE `tools/adobe-affinity.md` SHA 05d00b5330c1 BUILT 2026-08-15

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